

Participant information sheet

World Museum Storytelling Workshop Observation

Version 1, 12th June

Research ethics approval number:

Name of researcher(s): Dr Hannah Little (Principal Investigator), Nathan Bramald (Research Assistant)

You are being invited to participate in a research study. Before you decide whether to participate, it is important for you to understand why the research is being done and what it will involve. Please take time to read the following information carefully and feel free to ask us if you would like more information or if there is anything that you do not understand. We would like to stress that you do not have to accept this invitation and should only agree to take part if you want to.

Background

Dr Hannah Little is researching the use of storytelling techniques for effective science communication within museums. The research is interested in how storytelling techniques can engage people with natural history objects. As part of this research, we are conducting workshops in the museum, which you are participating in. As part of these workshops, we would like to observe participants, how they interact with the objects, the space and how they engage with the activities.

However, participation is entirely voluntary, and you are free to request that you are not observed at any time without explanation, and without incurring a disadvantage. If you would like to request we do not observe you, you will be provided with a lanyard which lets us know.

If you are willing to take part in this research, your participation will only require you to take part in the workshop as you normally would.

We may note down some demographic information about you (such as your assumed gender and approximate age), but you will be anonymous in any notes. Results of the observation may be analysed for academic publications (e.g. journal papers or academic book chapters) and will be used to inform a toolkit about how to design public engagement initiatives in museums.

No personal data will be recorded. However, the University processes personal data as part of its research and teaching activities in accordance with the lawful basis of 'public task', and in accordance with the University's purpose of advancing education, learning and research for the public benefit.

Under UK data protection legislation, the University acts as the Data Controller for personal data collected as part of the University's research. Dr. Hannah Little acts as the Data Processor for this study, and any queries relating to the handling of your personal data can be sent to Hannah.Little@liverpool.ac.uk.

Your data will be anonymous and any identifying information will be removed from the observation notes.

Further information on how your data will be used can be found in the table below.

How will my data be collected?	Notes will be take on how participants interact with exhibits, objects, the space and how they engage with the activities.
How will my data be stored?	Observation notes will be digitised and stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool. Only Dr Hannah Little and Nathan Bramald (Research assistant) will have access to this server. Original paper notes will be destroyed once digitised.
How long will my data be stored for?	Private repositories of the data will be stored until the completion of the project and any resulting publications and reports have been published. Original paper notes will be destroyed once digitised (within 1 week of collection).
What measures are in place to protect the security and confidentiality of my data?	All data will be stored on a secure, password-protected server at the University of Liverpool which is only accessible by the research team (the principal investigator and research assistant).
Will my data be anonymised?	Yes, no identifying information will be stored.
How will my data be used?	The observation will be used to supplement evaluation of how the workshops were carried out and how people responded to them. This analysis will be published, for example as part of journal papers or academic book chapters.
Who will have access to my data?	Only the principal investigator and research assistant will have access to original data.
Will my data be archived for use in other research projects in the future?	No
How will my data be destroyed?	Data will be deleted once the project has concluded and resulting reports have been published. Original paper notes will be destroyed with a university-approved confidential paper waste company.

Will I be remunerated for my time?

No, survey participants will not be remunerated for their time.

Are there any benefits in taking part?

You will be able to take part in an exciting, interactive workshop where you will see objects from behind the scenes of the museum, rarely seen by other visitors. You will be helping the museum improve its understanding of the effectiveness of this workshop, which in turn will feed into better designed events and activities available for visitors.

Are there any risks in taking part?

There are no known risks in relation to participating in these surveys. You may opt out of the observation at any time. If any participant experiences discomfort or disadvantage as part of the research, they should make the principal investigator (Dr Hannah Litte) aware immediately.

What will happen to the results of the study?

The results will inform recommendations for museum activities and form the basis of journal publications and book chapters.

What will happen if I want to stop taking part?

You can withdraw your participation in the study at any time without explanation during the observation. After the observation has taken place, it will no longer be possible to ask for notes relating to your participating to be destroyed, as it may be difficult to know what parts of the notes pertain to your specifically.

If you withdraw part-way through a observation, observations recorded before your withdrawal will not be discarded.

What if I am unhappy or if there is a problem?

If you are unhappy, or if there is a problem, please feel free to let us know by contacting Dr Hannah Little (hannah.little@liverpool.ac.uk) and we will try to help. If you remain unhappy or have a complaint which you feel you cannot come to us with then you should contact the Research Ethics and Integrity Office at ethics@liv.ac.uk. When contacting the Research Ethics and Integrity Office, please provide details of the name or description of the study (so that it can be identified), the researcher(s) involved, and the details of the complaint you wish to make.

The University strives to maintain the highest standards of rigour in the processing of your data. However, if you have any concerns about the way in which the University processes your personal data, it is important that you are aware of your right to lodge a complaint with the Information Commissioner's Office by calling 0303 123 1113.

Who can I contact if I have further questions?

Any queries should be directed to the principal investigator:

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